UNIT 24.3 · LEVEL B1

Possibility & deduction (in the present)

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 The lights are on. They _____ be at home.

a) can't **b)** shouldn't **c)** must **d)** mustn't

2 He's been working all day. He _____ be very tired.

a) must **b)** can't **c)** might not **d)** won't

3 That _____ be Tom. He's in Spain.

a) must **b)** might **c)** should **d)** can't

4 I'm not sure, but it _____ rain later.

a) can't **b)** might **c)** must **d)** mustn't

5 She's wearing a uniform. She _____ be a nurse.

a) can't **b)** must **c)** couldn't **d)** won't

6 He _____ be sleeping now. I'm not sure.

a) must **b)** can't **c)** shouldn't **d)** could

7 You've just eaten lunch. You _____ be hungry!

a) can't **b)** must **c)** may **d)** might

8 They _____ be at the cinema. I'm not certain.

a) must **b)** can't **c)** may **d)** mustn't

9 The shop is closed. It _____ be open.

a) must **b)** may **c)** should **d)** can't

10 I _____ go to the party. I haven't decided yet.

a) might **b)** must **c)** can't **d)** mustn't

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 He's got three cars. He _____ be rich.

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12 That _____ be true! It's impossible.

13 I'm not sure where she is. She _____ be at work.

14 The door is open. Someone _____ be inside.

15 It _____ snow tonight, but I'm not sure.

16 He _____ be the manager. He's only 19!

17 They _____ be at home. Their car is outside.

18 Don't wait for me. I _____ be late.

19 This _____ be your bag. Yours is blue.

20 Ask Paula. She _____ know the answer.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **She / must / be / at / work.**

_____

22 **That / can't / be / his / car.**

_____

23 **It / might / rain / this / afternoon.**

_____

24 **He / must / be / very / tired / after / the / trip.**

_____

25 **They / could / be / in / the / garden.**

_____

26 **You / can't / be / hungry / already!**

_____

27 **Maria / may / know / the / answer.**

_____

28 **The / phone / is / ringing. / It / must / be / Tom.**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the correct form.*
The lights are on, so he _____ at home.
Options: **can't be** / **must be** / **mustn't be**

30 *Choose the correct form.*
That _____ my bag. Mine is red.
Options: **must be** / **can't be** / **might to be**

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31 *Choose the correct form.*
I'm not sure, but it _____ snow tonight.
Options: **must** / **can't** / **might**

32 *Choose the correct form.*
She has a big house. She _____ rich.
Options: **can't be** / **must be** / **won't be**

33 *Choose the correct form.*
They _____ at the gym. I'm not sure.
Options: **must be** / **can't be** / **may be**

34 *Choose the correct form.*
He's only ten, so he _____ a doctor.
Options: **must be** / **can't be** / **might to be**

35 *Choose the correct form.*
Take an umbrella. It _____ rain later.
Options: **must** / **could** / **can't**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each degree of certainty.

1. 100% sure it's true _____
2. 100% sure it's not true _____
3. 50% sure _____
4. Possible _____

A. can't be
B. could be
C. must be
D. might be

37 Match each clue to a deduction.

1. The lights are off. _____
2. He's wearing a uniform. _____
3. I'm unsure about the weather. _____
4. She's crying. _____

A. She must be sad.
B. They can't be at home.
C. He must be a pilot.
D. It might rain.

38 Match each sentence to its meaning.

1. She must be here _____
2. She can't be here _____
3. She might be here _____
4. She is here _____

A. This is a fact
B. Perhaps she is
C. I'm sure she isn't
D. I'm sure she is

39 Match each modal to its use.

1. must _____
2. can't _____
3. might _____
4. could _____

A. impossible
B. weak possibility
C. possible
D. strong deduction

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40 Match each wrong sentence to the correct one.

1. He must to be late. _____
2. It mights rain. _____
3. She can't is here. _____
4. They may are lost. _____

A. She can't be here.
B. He must be late.
C. They may be lost.
D. It might rain.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 He must to be at home. Correct word: _____

42 She mustn't be at home. The lights are off.
Correct word: _____

43 They might are late. Correct word: _____

44 It musts be true. Correct word: _____

45 That can't is Maria. Correct word: _____

46 She mights be ill. Correct word: _____

47 I think he must to know the answer. Correct word: _____

48 It could to be dangerous. Correct word: _____

49 He mustn't be Tom. Tom is taller. Correct word: _____

50 We may to be late. Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Possibility & deduction (in the present)

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** must	Strong deduction: must.
2	**a)** must	Logical conclusion: must.
3	**d)** can't	Impossible: can't.
4	**b)** might	Weak possibility: might.
5	**b)** must	Strong deduction: must.
6	**d)** could	Possibility: could.
7	**a)** can't	Impossible: can't.
8	**c)** may	Possibility: may.
9	**d)** can't	Impossible: can't.
10	**a)** might	Possibility: might.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**must**	Strong deduction.
12	**can't** (or: cannot)	Impossible.
13	**might** (or: may, could)	Possibility.
14	**must**	Strong deduction.
15	**might** (or: may, could)	Possibility.
16	**can't** (or: cannot)	Impossible.
17	**must**	Strong deduction.
18	**might** (or: may, could)	Possibility.
19	**can't** (or: cannot)	Impossible.
20	**might** (or: may, could)	Possibility.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**She must be at work.**	Must + base verb.
22	**That can't be his car.**	Can't = impossible.
23	**It might rain this afternoon.**	Might = possibility.
24	**He must be very tired after the trip.**	Strong deduction.
25	**They could be in the garden.**	Could = possibility.
26	**You can't be hungry already!**	Impossible.
27	**Maria may know the answer.**	May = possibility.

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28	**The phone is ringing. It must be Tom.**	Strong deduction.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**must be**	Strong deduction.
30	**can't be**	Impossible.
31	**might**	Possibility.
32	**must be**	Strong deduction.
33	**may be**	Possibility.
34	**can't be**	Impossible.
35	**could**	Possibility.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	100% sure it's true – must be; 100% sure it's not true – can't be; 50% sure – might be; Possible – could be Choose the right modal.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	The lights are off. – They can't be at home.; He's wearing a uniform. – He must be a pilot.; I'm unsure about the weather. – It might rain.; She's crying. – She must be sad. Use the clue.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	She must be here – I'm sure she is; She can't be here – I'm sure she isn't; She might be here – Perhaps she is; She is here – This is a fact Certainty levels.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	must – strong deduction; can't – impossible; might – weak possibility; could – possible Learn the uses.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	He must to be late. – He must be late.; It mights rain. – It might rain.; She can't is here. – She can't be here.; They may are lost. – They may be lost. Modal + base verb.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**must be** (or: he must be)	No "to" after modals.
42	**can't be** (or: cannot be)	Impossible: can't be.
43	**might be** (or: they might be)	Modal + base verb.
44	**must be** (or: it must be)	Modals have no -s.
45	**can't be** (or: cannot be)	Modal + base verb.
46	**might be** (or: may be, could be)	Modals have no -s.
47	**must know** (or: he must know)	No "to" after modals.
48	**could be** (or: may be, might be)	No "to" after modals.
49	**can't be** (or: cannot be)	Impossible: can't be.
50	**may be** (or: might be, could be)	No "to" after modals.

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